

regulars. In November 1964, North Vietnamese troops started infiltrating South Vietnam via the Ho Chi Minh Trail.

“[The] **atmosphere** fairly **smelled of discontent**, with workers **on strike**, **students demonstrating**.”

GENERAL WILLIAM WESTMORELAND, MARCH 1964

» AFTER

Johnson's reluctance to escalate the war evaporated after direct attacks on US interests.

TONKIN RESOLUTION

In the summer of 1964, the Viet Cong launched attacks on two US destroyers in the Gulf of Tonkin. Within days of the second attack, the US House of Representatives passed the **Tonkin Resolution**, authorizing use of armed force in Vietnam.

BOMBING NORTH VIETNAM

After an attack on Pleiku, a US air base, in February 1965, Johnson authorized **retaliatory airstrikes**.